

Test Edge Cases and Fairness

Project: Helpful Classroom Sorter

1. Your mission

Your learning target

I can choose tests just below, at and above a decision boundary.

I can distinguish valid no-match requests from invalid input.

I can use labelled catalogue variations to examine previously untested paths.

Remember before reading

Close your notes first. A rough first answer helps us choose the right starting point; it is not a score for your ability.

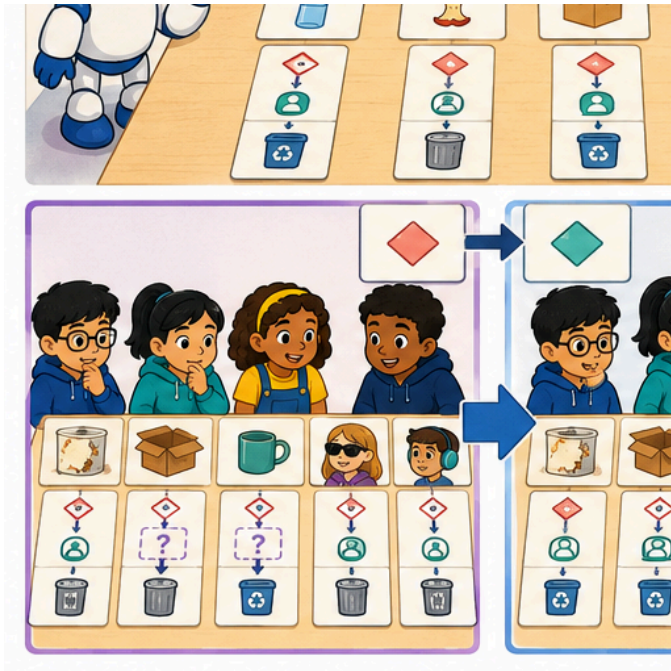
Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Test Normal Cases. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Design the Decision Process. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Humans Set Boundaries. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

After trying, check the relevant lesson or ask your teacher. Change the part of your explanation that the evidence shows was wrong.

Unusual and underrepresented cases reveal hidden assumptions.



LEARNING TARGET Before testing, define outcomes for clean paper, metal foil, mixed packaging and an unreadable card. The team later changes mixed packaging's expected result to match its sorter. Explain the evaluation problem.

Learner name:

Readiness for the connected explanation

Why can four successful routine cases leave a mistake undiscovered?

This week's end goal

By the end, I can design boundary and coverage tests instead of assuming routine success is enough.

2. Notice the evidence

PICTURE STORY

Look Closely Before You Explain

Pictures give clues; evidence tells us what the clues mean.



MYSTERY A worn notebook, multilingual label, partly hidden item, and object fitting two bins reveal assumptions normal tests miss.

What do you notice?

Name three visible details without explaining them yet.

Circle the detail most connected to the system's decision.

Name one detail that may be decoration or distraction.

Make a first prediction and state the clue that supports it.

My observations, prediction, and evidence:

GOOD THINKING A prediction can change when stronger evidence appears.

A closer explanation

Routine examples can miss a mistake at an exact limit. This week you will choose revealing cases around those limits and vary the paper catalogue to reach later successful outputs. Write expected results from the requirements before operating the prototype. Keep its saved instructions and each test record so a failure remains useful evidence.

Catalogue B version 1 is unchanged: B1 Bookmark drawing, 10 minutes, quiet Yes; B2 Story circle, 8 minutes, quiet No; B3 Pattern puzzle, 12 minutes, quiet Yes; B4 Tower challenge, 15 minutes, quiet No. Search in that order. These fictional paper values assume materials are available. Inputs are whole minutes from 0 to 30 inclusive and Quiet required Yes or No. No allows quiet or nonquiet activities.

Time fits when required minutes are no more than available minutes, including equality. The quiet condition

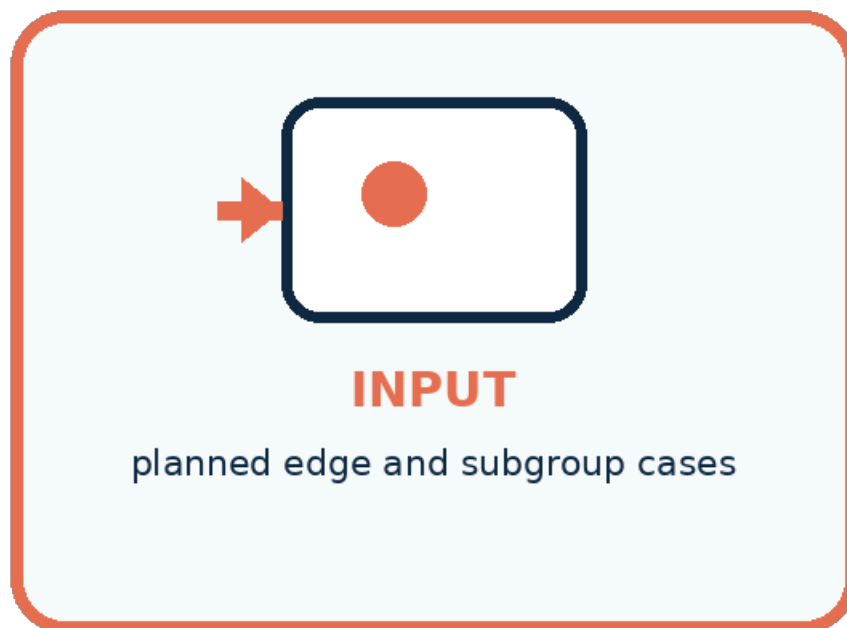
must also hold. Select the first fitting row with a correct reason, or report no match after every row fails. Invalid or missing input requires clarification before searching. P1 validates, resets to the first row, checks both conditions, advances after failure and stops at the first fit or catalogue exhaustion. No output books or publishes anything.

3. See how it works

VISUAL MECHANISM

Input → Process → Output

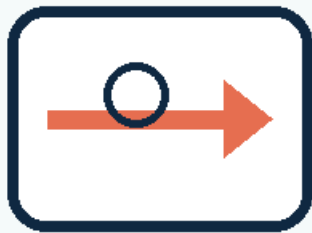
Follow the information instead of imagining magic inside the machine.





PROCESS

run same version and compare error patterns



OUTPUT

documented gaps, harms, and repair priorities

INPUT planned edge and subgroup cases

PROCESS run same version and compare error patterns

OUTPUT documented gaps, harms, and repair priorities

CORE IDEA Unusual and underrepresented cases reveal hidden assumptions.

UNDER THE HOOD Edge testing explores boundaries, rare combinations, missing values, adversarial ambiguity, and subgroup conditions. Fairness analysis asks whether error burdens differ and whether fallback paths remain usable.

Draw a fresh example with all three stages:

A closer explanation

Three requests around ten minutes

Available time · Check B1 time · Result for quiet Yes

Available time: 9 minutes

Check B1 time: 10 is too long

Result for quiet Yes: No match in catalogue B

Available time: 10 minutes

Check B1 time: 10 fits exactly

Result for quiet Yes: Suggest B1

Available time: 11 minutes

Check B1 time: 10 fits with time left

Result for quiet Yes: Suggest B1

Keep Quiet required Yes and catalogue B version 1 fixed while changing available time.

For quiet requests, 10 minutes is the first time a catalogue activity fits. Test 9, 10 and 11 with Yes so only the time changes. A faulty comparison S version 0 uses strictly less than instead of no more than for time, while keeping the other P1 rules. It rejects B1 at exactly 10. With quiet required, every later row also fails, so it incorrectly reports no match.

S can pass all four routine requests from Week 33: 11 Yes, 9 No, 6 No and 9 Yes. None has a fitting activity whose duration equals the request. The 10 Yes case reveals a gap those passes did not close. Another useful boundary is 8 minutes with No: equality should allow B2, while 7 No has no match. Keep both quiet values in your wider plan because No does not mean nonquiet only.

Connect the picture and the explanation

Point to the input, the deciding step and the result in this week's visual. Explain the same step in ordinary words. A picture helps when you can say what each part represents.

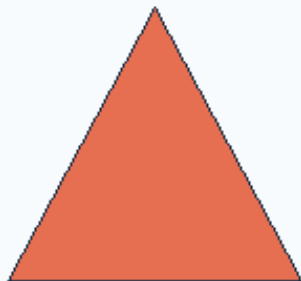
4. Compare the cases

Four Cases, Four Clues

Use the visual cue, then read the evidence carefully.



Worn label



Two-bin object



Different language



Blank card

CASE 1 — Worn label Clue: text partly missing. Meaning: degraded input.

CASE 2 — Two-bin object Clue: categories overlap. Meaning: boundary case.

CASE 3 — Different language Clue: label format changes. Meaning: access/fairness case.

CASE 4 — Blank card Clue: required input absent. Meaning: missing-data case.

BOUNDARY Edge cases are not excuses to blame users for being unusual; they are evidence about design limits.

Which two pictures are easiest to confuse? What evidence separates them?

Change one thing in the pictured case

Change: Faulty code uses duration strictly below available time.

Prediction: Request 6 now wrongly returns none.

Reason: A's duration equals the available time and should be eligible under at most.

5. Words that unlock the idea

VOCABULARY

Words You Can See and Use

The badge is a memory cue; the definition does the real thinking work.





underrepresented



subgroup test



hidden assumption

Word · Meaning · My example

Word: edge case

Meaning: unusual input near a system limit

My example: _____

Word: underrepresented

Meaning: rare or absent in design evidence

My example: _____

Word: subgroup test

Meaning: check for one relevant condition or user group

My example: _____

Word: hidden assumption

Meaning: unstated belief revealed by failure

My example: _____

Misconception detective

CLAIM TO REPAIR Rare cases do not matter.

Use one vocabulary word and one piece of evidence to repair it:

WORD POWER A strong definition helps you decide something in a new case.

Words used in the closer explanation

Word · Meaning

Word: Boundary

Meaning: A value where an input changes category or a condition changes truth

Word: Inclusive

Meaning: Including the stated endpoint or equal value

Word: Invalid input

Meaning: A value that does not meet the agreed input rules

Word: Test variation

Meaning: A documented change in the conditions used for a test

Word: Coverage gap

Meaning: A relevant condition or behaviour the current tests have not examined

6. Follow a worked example

WORKED EXAMPLE

Watch the Reasoning, Not Just the Answer

Every step connects a claim to observable evidence.



CASE A worn notebook, multilingual label, partly hidden item, and object fitting two bins reveal assumptions normal tests miss.

STEP 1 — OBSERVE planned edge and subgroup cases

STEP 2 — TRACE run same version and compare error patterns

STEP 3 — CONCLUDE documented gaps, harms, and repair priorities

MODEL REASONING Use the same frozen prototype, log outcomes by condition, and compare error types. Prioritize failures with high burden or no usable fallback, then design a targeted repair without stereotyping users.

DO NOT OVERCLAIM Edge cases are not excuses to blame users for being unusual; they are evidence about design limits.

What new evidence could change this answer?

A closer explanation

Request using catalogue B · Expected response · Reason

Request using catalogue B: 0 minutes Yes

Expected response: No match

Reason: Zero is valid; every activity needs more time

Request using catalogue B: 30 minutes Yes

Expected response: B1 with a matching reason

Reason: 30 is valid; B1 is the first fit

Request using catalogue B: 31 minutes Yes

Expected response: Clarify minutes; no search

Reason: 31 is outside the accepted range

Request using catalogue B: Blank minutes with Yes

Expected response: Clarify minutes; no search

Reason: The time field is missing

Request using catalogue B: 10.5 minutes Yes

Expected response: Clarify minutes; no search

Reason: The accepted time must be a whole number

Request using catalogue B: 10 minutes with blank quiet

Expected response: Clarify quiet; no search

Reason: Choose Yes or No before searching

The accepted range and activity durations are different kinds of boundary. Zero belongs to the valid range even though no activity fits. Thirty also belongs to it. A negative time, such as minus one minute, is below zero and invalid. Do not change a blank to zero, round 10.5 to 10 or turn a blank quiet choice into No. Ask for the field to be corrected and start a new validated run.

A test record should say whether a search is expected to begin. Clarification should name the field needing correction; it should not claim the catalogue has no suitable activity. Test an unrecognised quiet value such as Maybe as well as a missing value. These check different forms of unusable input.

Learn from the worked case

Cover the result before checking it. Say what is given, choose the procedure, and follow one step at a time. Then uncover the result and explain your first mismatch. Ask why a step is allowed, not only what number it produces.

A pictorial worked case: Test Edge Cases and Fairness

A fictional craft-book chooser accepts requests for whole available minutes from 0 to 20.

The facts we will use

Booklet A takes 6 minutes; B takes 12. Return first duration at most available time.

Check 5,6,7; also 0,20,21 and blank. Same catalogue applies to every user.

AI ACADEMY / AI-1/34

Test Edge Cases and Fairness

Start with the supplied facts

Follow each arrow. Ask which fact allows the next step.



1. Near a boundary

At 5: none. At 6 and 7: A.



2. Valid extremes

0: none. 20: A, because first-fit order remains fixed.



3. Invalid inputs

21 and blank require clarification, not ordinary search.



4. Coverage record

Record each user condition tested; do not invent unrun outcomes.

CHANGE ONE THING

Faulty code uses duration strictly below available time.

Explain the changed result using the matching lesson.

Read the picture one step at a time

Step · What happens and why

Step: 1. Near a boundary

What happens and why: At 5: none. At 6 and 7: A.

Step: 2. Valid extremes

What happens and why: 0: none. 20: A, because first-fit order remains fixed.

Step: 3. Invalid inputs

What happens and why: 21 and blank require clarification, not ordinary search.

Step: 4. Coverage record

What happens and why: Record each user condition tested; do not invent unrun outcomes.

Match each pictured step to the supplied facts. This is a worked teaching case, not an independent assessment.

Why this result follows

Adjacent values below, at and above 6 expose an accidental strict inequality. Zero is valid even though no activity fits. The top valid input does not require selecting the longest activity: catalogue order still controls selection. Coverage also asks whose conditions were tested, which cannot be inferred from these numbers alone.

What this example does not establish

Equal written rules do not prove equally good outcomes for every group; actual condition-specific evidence is still needed.

7. Find and repair a mistake

COMPARE

Same Result, Different Reason

A comparison helps reveal the true concept boundary.

Case · Evidence · What it shows

Case: Worn label

Evidence: text partly missing

What it shows: degraded input

Case: Two-bin object

Evidence: categories overlap

What it shows: boundary case

Case: Different language

Evidence: label format changes

What it shows: access/fairness case

Case: Blank card

Evidence: required input absent

What it shows: missing-data case

Repair two tempting claims

CLAIM A Rare cases do not matter.

Repair:

CLAIM B One special test represents every member of a subgroup.

Repair:

STRONG ANSWER FRAME I claim _____ because the evidence shows _____. The process is _____. One limit is _____.

A closer explanation

Label each case by its purpose: time equality, accepted-range endpoint, invalid field or catalogue variation. Record the exact catalogue version and request, the expected output and explanation, and what actually happened. Compare the prototype with the manual baseline under identical conditions. Count every attempted case, retain failures, and distinguish cases not yet run from successful tests.

These are development tests that can guide repairs. Keep any final evaluation cases reserved by your teacher separate until the prototype version is fixed for evaluation. Even a broad development set does not establish real-world enjoyment, material availability or speed. Next week you will repair a located defect and check whether the change breaks behaviour that worked before.

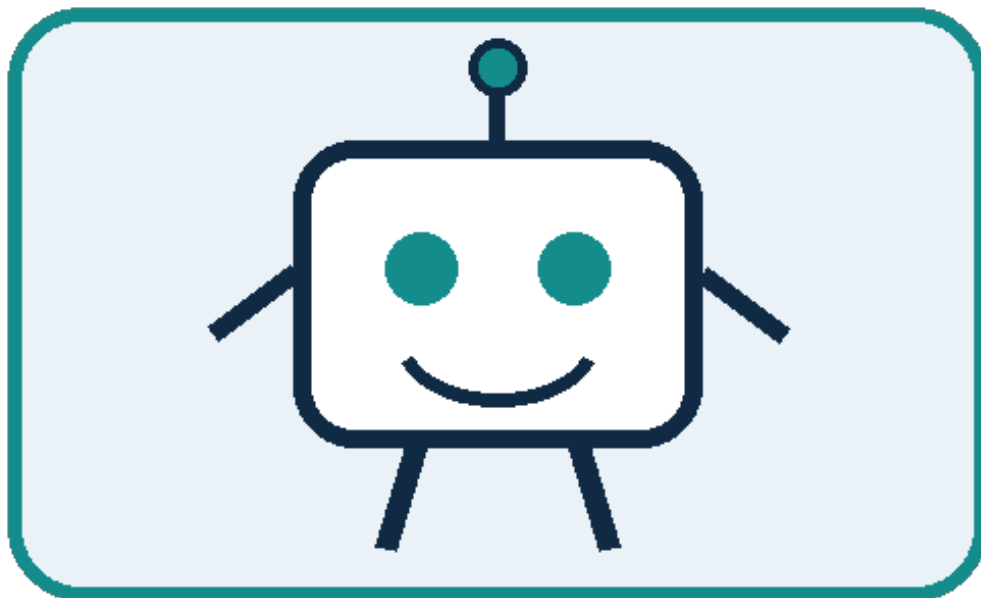
S passes the four routine cases but fails 10 Yes by reporting no match. Explain which comparison to inspect and why changing the expected answer to no match would be wrong. Give one additional equality case and one invalid-input case, including their expected outcomes.

8. Practise together

GUIDED PRACTICE

Try It, Check It, Explain It

Use support now so you can succeed independently later.



Explain how the picture story demonstrates this idea: Unusual and underrepresented cases reveal hidden assumptions.

Use a fresh example to explain edge case.

Trace a new input → process → output example.

Find and repair the error in: One special test represents every member of a subgroup.

Invent one edge case and name the safe response.

PARTNER CHECK Point to the evidence. Do not accept an answer that only repeats the vocabulary word.

A closer explanation

In B version 1, earlier B1 always fits whenever B3 or B4 could be chosen. To test a successful later-row path, make a labelled copy of the catalogue. Keep the input rules, both compatibility conditions and first-match rule unchanged. Both the prototype and manual baseline must read the same test copy. Do not overwrite the original catalogue or reuse its expected answers for the changed data.

Test copy B version 2 changes only B1's duration from 10 to 20 minutes. All other rows, quiet labels and order stay as in version 1. For 12 Yes, B1 is now too long, B2 is not quiet, and B3 fits exactly and is quiet. The expected first suggestion is B3. This checks a third-row success and equality under a documented variation.

Make test copy B version 3 with durations B1 20, B2 18, B3 17 and B4 15 minutes. Keep the original quiet labels and order. For 15 No, trace the rows and give the required output and reason. Then use 15 Yes with the same copy. Explain why the outcomes differ and what must be written on both test records.

Practise with less help: Check the validation boundary

Use workbook W2 for the connected example "Testing boundaries and varied conditions". First fill the input and rule boxes. Try the middle steps before asking for a hint. After a hint, try the next step yourself.

Plan · Do · Check

Plan: What is given? Which rule or procedure applies?

Do: Record each intermediate step.

Check: Does the result follow? What remains unknown?

Explain your trace to a partner. Your partner points to one step to check. Swap roles on the next case. Each person writes their own explanation.

Check your reasoning

Use the worked case for Testing boundaries and varied conditions. Proposed explanation: “At the limit means outside the rule”. Decide whether this explanation is supported. Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Answer on your own before discussion. If you are unsure, say which step you need help with.

Explain the picture

Which single boundary run most directly detects the strict-comparison bug, and why?

My explanation using a pictured step and the given facts

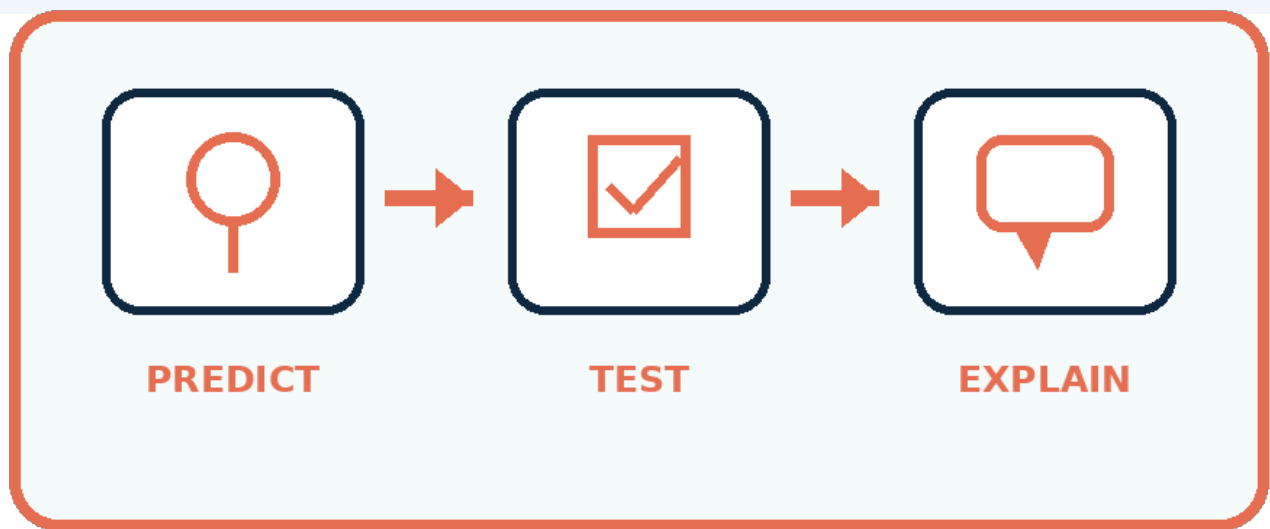
This is supported practice. Keep the separately named independent case for an attempt before feedback.

9. Run the investigation

EXPLORER LAB

Edge and Fairness Test Pack

Predict first, test honestly, and explain what the evidence means.



- State your prediction before the result is known.
- Complete the task: Add missing, ambiguous, and subgroup test cards.
- Keep a normal case and an edge case clearly separated.
- Record what happened—even when it does not match your prediction.
- Explain the result, one limitation, and the next useful test.

Case · Prediction · Observed result · What it means

Case: Normal

Prediction: _____

Observed result: _____

What it means: _____

Case: Edge

Prediction: _____

Observed result: _____

What it means: _____

INDEPENDENCE After support is removed, repeat the proof with a fresh case.

Plan → try → check

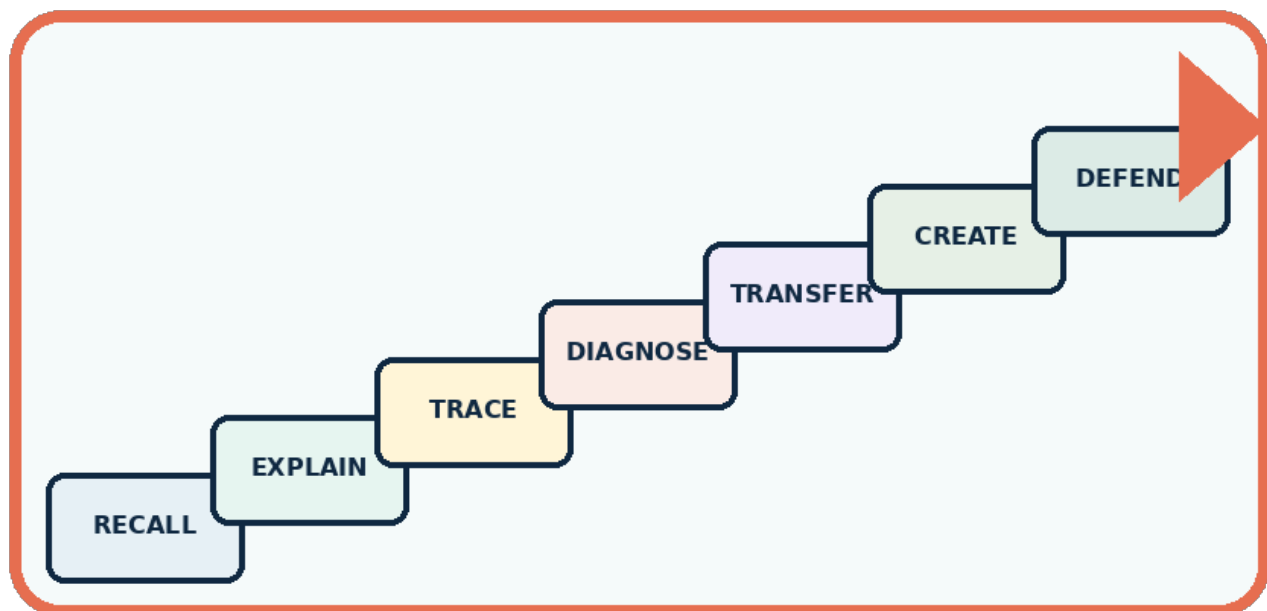
Before trying: what do I expect, and why? While trying: which step could first go wrong? Afterwards: what did I actually observe, and what should change? Keep “not run” if you only traced the procedure.

10. Build your understanding

PRACTICE LADDER

Climb from Recall to Defense

Each step asks for a stronger kind of understanding.



RECALL Define edge case.

EXPLAIN Unusual and underrepresented cases reveal hidden assumptions.

TRACE Show the input, process, and output.

DIAGNOSE Repair: Rare cases do not matter.

TRANSFER Apply the idea to a new home or classroom case.

CREATE Design one revealing test.

DEFEND Give a claim, evidence, mechanism, limit, and safe action.

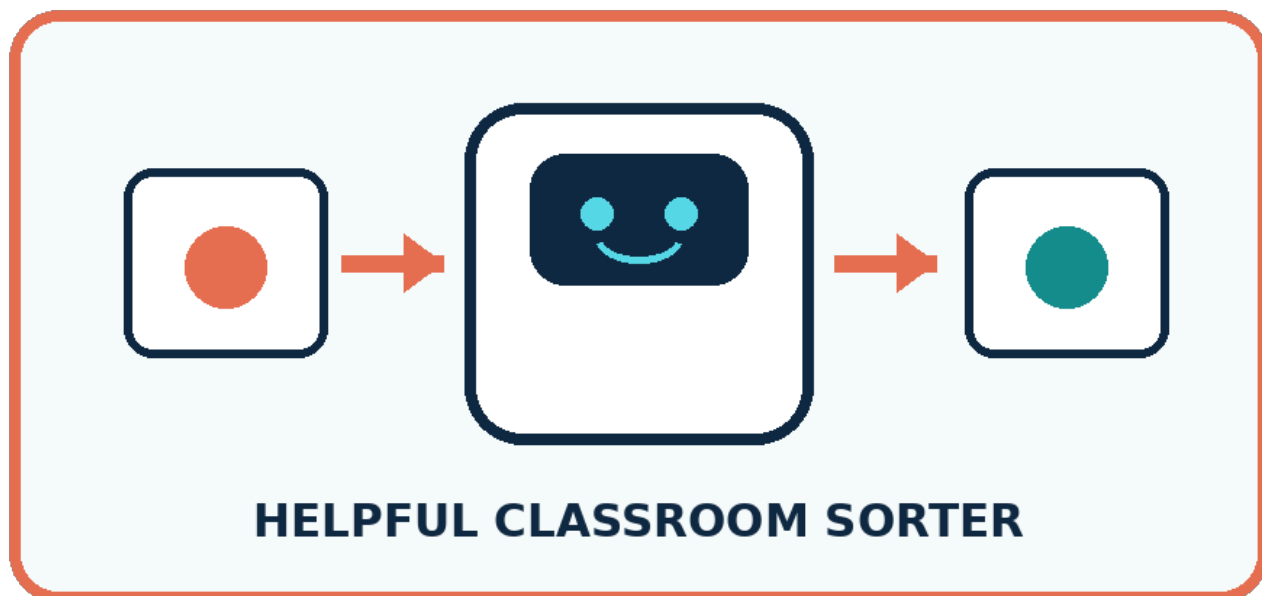
RETRY RULE A coached answer becomes mastery only after you solve a different case independently.

11. Connect your project

PROJECT

Helpful Classroom Sorter

Build one coherent system across the year, one evidence-based decision at a time.



THIS WEEK'S CHECKPOINT Expand the sorter test suite with edge, missing-data, and fairness cases plus expected safe behavior.

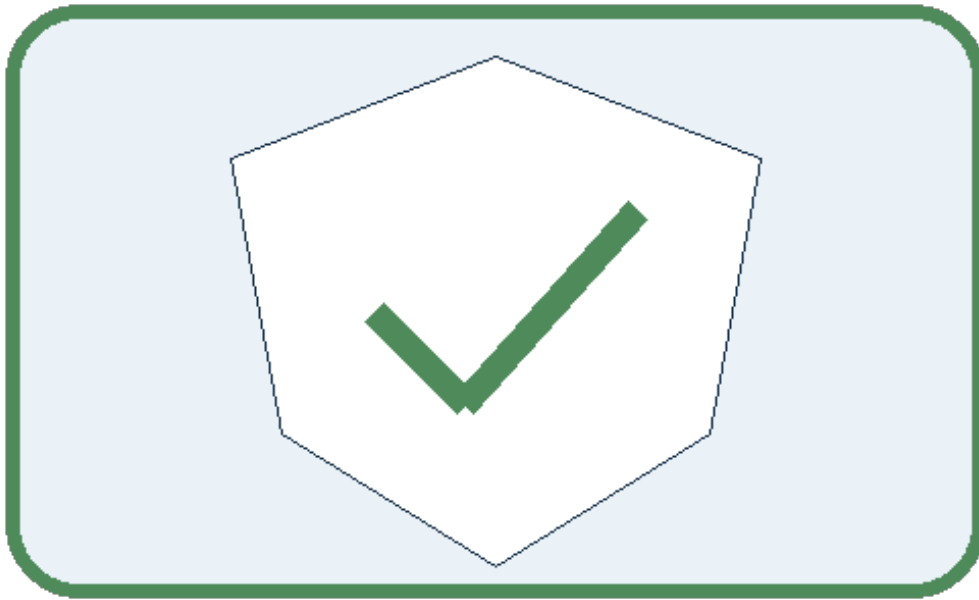
What real classroom need does this serve?

What information is necessary—and what should stay private?

What happens inside the process?

What normal and edge cases will you test?

When should it say not sure or ask a person?



RESPONSIBLE DESIGN Edge cases are not excuses to blame users for being unusual; they are evidence about design limits.

My project decision:

Evidence for your project

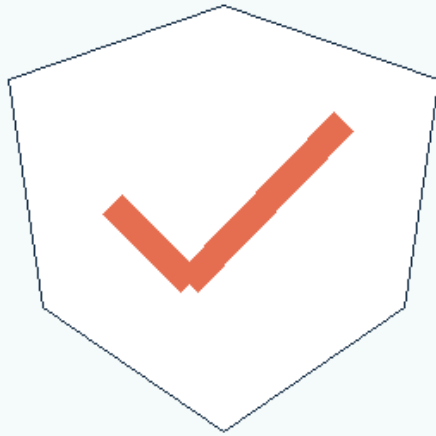
Add sorter boundary cases, missing fields and relevant user conditions to the test plan before making fairness claims.

12. Show what you know

MASTERY

Fresh-Case Independent Proof

Complete this after teaching and guided practice have ended.



INDEPENDENT PROOF

REQUIRED PROOF Add missing, ambiguous, and subgroup test cards, compare results, and name one hidden assumption.

- ☐ Name or draw the fresh case.
- ☐ Trace input, process, and output.
- ☐ State the conclusion and strongest evidence.
- ☐ Name one limit, failure, missing clue, or fairness/privacy concern.
- ☐ Explain one safe next action or improvement.

Independent evidence:

SELF-CHECK Use the same frozen prototype, log outcomes by condition, and compare error types. Prioritize failures with high burden or no usable fallback, then design a targeted repair without stereotyping users.

My level: ☐ Not yet ☐ With one hint ☐ Independently ☐ I can teach it

NEXT BRIDGE Carry today's evidence habit into: Improve One Cause.

13. Study a complete case

Week 34 Worked case

Use the supplied details to practise the weekly concept before attempting the independent question. This

case extends the illustrated lesson.

The situation

A sorter handles clean paper but fails on crumpled paper and mixed packaging.

The question

Design revealing tests.

Worked explanation

Use separately labelled clean, crumpled and mixed cases with expected outputs or review actions declared first. Compare conditions.

Explain it in your own words

Which detail supports the answer, and why does it matter?

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Trace the supplied case visually

Test conditions that reveal limitations

Evidence or stage · Value or result

Evidence or stage: Clean paper

Value or result: Routine case

Evidence or stage: Crumpled paper

Value or result: Changed condition

Evidence or stage: Mixed packaging

Value or result: Ambiguous material

Evidence or stage: Expected action

Value or result: Declare tray or review before testing

A sorter handles clean paper but fails on crumpled paper and mixed packaging.

Design revealing tests.

Use separately labelled clean, crumpled and mixed cases with expected outputs or review actions declared first. Compare conditions.

14. Try a new case independently

Independent case: Find an independent capacity boundary

A new equipment selector lists E1 first, capacity 4; E2 second, capacity 8. Valid group size is a whole number from 1 to 10. Choose the first item whose capacity is at least the group size, or no match; invalid input needs clarification. A faulty version uses capacity strictly greater than group size. Independently give correct and faulty outputs for groups 3, 4 and 5, then for group 8. Explain the defect and give the correct response to group 0. No booking occurs.

My independent explanation, trace and limits

Attempt this case before feedback. Record any help. Earlier examples below are further practice; a case already practised with feedback cannot establish fresh transfer.

Week 34 Independent application

Close the worked explanation. Apply the idea to this different question without copying.

A sorter works on clear photos. Test a blurred pencil, a dim book and an unfamiliar lunch box. What makes these useful tests?

My answer, with a trace, calculation or supporting evidence

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Create and test

Change one relevant detail. Predict the result before testing. Include a boundary or missing-information case when it helps reveal a limit.

My changed input and expected result

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Connect to your project

Expand the sorter test suite with edge, missing-data, and fairness cases plus expected safe behavior.

The evidence I will keep

Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

Your teacher has the independent answer and scoring criteria. Complete the matching workbook week to

keep your practice evidence together.

Transfer practice from the original programme

Before testing, define outcomes for clean paper, metal foil, mixed packaging and an unreadable card. The team later changes mixed packaging's expected result to match its sorter. Explain the evaluation problem.

Explain the mechanism, evidence and one limit.

Use feedback to improve

Attempt the independent case before hints. Record whether you worked alone, used a hint or followed a model. After feedback, fix the first unsupported step and explain why it changed. A later check uses a changed case, not a copied answer.